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漢字 3: Dawn (旦)

Dawn.		
This glyph features more often as a component in other 漢字.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	日 + 一
English	Sun + One

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Dawn is stage [one] of the [day].
The dawn of the [sun] is [one] spectacle to behold.

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	タン (TAN)	—
L.C.	ダン (DAN)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Dawn <DUNKING> by the <TONS>.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
*一旦	once + dawn = <i>once</i>	イッタン (IT·TAN)
元旦	basis + dawn = <i>New Year's Day</i>	ガン・タン (GAN·TAN)

{...} Sample Sentence

元旦	に	お寺	へ	行きました。
ガンタン	に	おてら	へ	いきました
New Year's Day	に	temple	へ	went
(I) went to a temple on New Year's Day.				

漢字 4: Black (黒)

Black.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	黒
English	Black

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#203).

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	コク (KOKU)	くろ (kuro)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Black <cool objects> <COCKS> my interests.

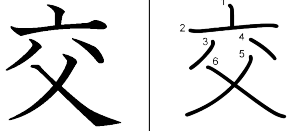
+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
With the exception of the third example, the 訓読み is always voiced in the second position (as it appears in the fourth compound).		
黒	<i>black (noun)</i>	くろ (kuro)
黒い	<i>black (adjective)</i>	くろい (kuroi)
白黒	white + black = <i>black-and-white</i>	しろくろ (shirokuro)
赤黒い	red + black = <i>dark red</i>	あか ぐろい (aka guroi)
黒人	black + person = <i>a black person</i>	コク・ジン (KOKU·JIN)

{...} Sample Sentence

此の	黒い	馬	は	美しい	ですね。
この	くろい	うま	は	うつくしい	ですね
this	black	horse	は	beautiful	isn't it
This black horse is beautiful, isn't it?					

漢字 5: Mix (交)



A general sense of things *mixing* in both physical and figurative ways. *Associating* with people or *exchanging* words are examples of the latter.

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	亠 + 父
English	Top/Lid + Father

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Mix	[toppings] for [father].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	コウ (KŌ)	ま (ma)
L.C.	—	まじ、か (maji, ka)

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

A mixup <CAUSED> by a <customer>
<muddying> <much information>.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
交ざる (intr.)	<i>to mingle</i>	まざる (mazaru)
交ぜる (tr.)	<i>to mix (something)</i>	まぜる (mazeru)
外交	outside + mix = <i>foreign policy</i>	ガイ・コウ (GAIKŌ)

{...} Sample Sentence

あの	国	の	外交	が	分かりません。
あの	くに	の	ガイコウ	が	わかりません
that	country	の	foreign policy	が	don't understand
(I) don't understand that country's foreign policy.					

漢字 6: Not (不)



Expressing the idea of “not” or “un-”. This is an important negating prefix in Japanese.

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	一 + 亻 + 丶
English	One + Person + dot

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components	
Not	[one] [person] without a [dot] of sin.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
Note how this 漢字 can function as a prefix with complete words, as it does in the final example.		
不意	not + mind = <i>unexpectedly</i>	フ・イ (FU-I)
不安	not + ease = <i>uneasy</i>	フ・アン (FU-AN)
不明	not + bright = <i>unclear</i>	フ・メイ (FU-MEI)
不死	not + death = <i>immortal</i>	フ・シ (FU-SHI)
不親切	not + parent + cut = <i>unkind</i>	フ・シン・セツ (FUSHINSETSU)

{...} Sample Sentence

小林さんの意図は不明です。		
Kobayashisan no ITO wa FU-MEI desu.		
(Kobayashi-san) (aim) (unclear)		
= Kobayashi-san's aim is unclear.		

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	フ (FU)	—
L.C.	ブ (BU)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Not	a <FOOFY> <BULLY>.
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漢字 7: After (後)

After. Later. Behind.

These meanings apply to the ideas of both physical location and time.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	イ + 彡 + 冬
English	Step + Short Thread + Winter

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

After [stepping] on the [short thread] in [winter].

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	コウ、ゴ (KŌ, GO)	あと、うし (ato, ushi)
Look for コウ in the first position; あと and うしろ (this reading is always accompanied by ろ), appear less frequently here.		
ゴ pops up in only a few words. In the second position, moreover, the reading will invariably be ゴ.		
L.C.	—	のち、おく (nochi, oku)

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

After <notching> your way up, <you ship> the <(GOBS) to <(CAUSE) the <atoll> to be <occupied>.

[‡]Atoll is a ring-shaped coral reef. [‡]Gob is a mass or lump.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
It is worth having another look at the compounds for 前 in Chapter 7 (Entry ??), to see how the fourth, fifth, and sixth examples given there “pair up” with the three below.		
後	after	あと (ato)
後ろ	behind	うしろ (ushiro)
後年	after + year = <i>in later years</i>	コウ・ネン (KŌ-NEN)
後半	after + half = <i>second half</i>	コウ・ハン (KŌ-HAN)
後者	after + individual = <i>the latter</i>	コウ・シャ (KŌ-SHA)
最後	most + after = <i>the last</i>	サイ・ゴ (SAIGO)
午後	noon + after = <i>P.M.; afternoon</i>	ゴ・ゴ (GOGO)

{...} Sample Sentence

後で友人と東京へ行きます。

ato de YŪ·JIN to TŌKYŌ e ikimasu.

(after) (friend) (with) (Tokyo) (go).

=Afterwards, I'll go to Tokyo with a friend.

漢字 8: Most (最)

Most.

Note how the first stroke of 耳 has been lengthened.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	日 + 取
English	Sun + Take (??)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Mostly the [sun] [takes] it all.

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	サイ (SAI)	—
L.C.	—	もっと、も (motto, mo)

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The most <(PSYCHEDELLIC) <moral> <motto>.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
最小	most + small = <i>smallest</i>	サイ・ショウ (SAISHŌ)
最少	most + few = <i>fewest</i>	サイ・ショウ (SAISHŌ)
最高	most + tall = <i>highest; the best</i>	サイ・コウ (SAIKŌ)
最古	most + old = <i>oldest</i>	サイ・コ (SAIKO)
最新	most + new = <i>newest</i>	サイ・シン (SAISHIN)
最後	most + after = <i>the last</i>	サイ・ゴ (SAIGO)

{...} Sample Sentence

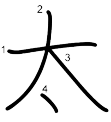
この天気は最高ですよ。

kono TEN·KI wa SAIKŌ desu yo.

(this) (weather) (the best) (is)

=This weather is fantastic.

漢字 9: Fat (太)

		
Fat/Thick. Note the difference between this character and 犬 (Entry ??).		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	大 + 丶
English	Large + Dot

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Fat [dots] are [large].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	タイ (TAI)	ふと (futo)
L.C.	タ (TA)	—

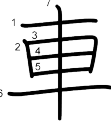
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The fat <futon> was <TIGHTLY> packed in the (TUB).

+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
太い	<i>fat; thick</i>	ふとーい (futoi)
太る	<i>to grow fat</i>	ふとる (futoru)
太子	fat + child = <i>crown prince</i>	タイシ (TAISHI)

{...} Sample Sentence
私は冬休みにとても太った。 watashi wa fuyu yasumi ni totemo futotta. (I) (winter vacation) (really) (grew fat) = I really put on weight during the winter vacation.

漢字 10: Car (車)

		
Car. As the compounds below indicate, this character can also refer to a wide range of other vehicles.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	車
English	Car/Cart

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Part of the 漢字 radicals (#159).

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	シャ (SHA)	くるま (kuruma)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The car was <SHUT> to hear a <cool rumour>.

+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
車	<i>car; vehicle</i>	くるま (kuruma)
電車	electric + car = (<i>electric</i>) train	デンシャ (DENSHA)
空車	empty + car = (<i>taxi</i>) "for hire"	クウシャ (KŪSHA)
車内	car + inside = <i>inside the car</i>	シャ・ナイ (SHA·NAI)
中古車	middle + old + car = <i>used car</i>	チュウコシャ (CHŪKOSHA)

{...} Sample Sentence
中村さんは中古車を買いました。 Naka-mura-san wa CHŪKOSHA o kaimashita. (Nakamura-san) (used car) (bought) = Nakamura-san bought a used car.

漢字 11: Receive (受)

		
Receive. Accept.		
This interesting character encompasses a wide range of meanings having to do with the idea of reception: “taking” an exam, “undergoing” an operation, or “suffering” injuries are several examples.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	爪 + 冖 + 又
English	Claw + Cover/Crown + Again

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Receive the [clawed] [crown] [again].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ジュ (JU)	う (u)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
Receive <JUDICIOUS> <oomph>.

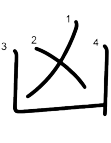
+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
The third and fourth examples below show this to be another 漢字 sharing the pronunciation characteristics of 買.		
受ける	to receive; to accept	うける (ukeru)
受け取る	receive + take = to receive	うけ とる (uke toru)
受取	receive + take = recipient	うけとり (uketori)
*受取人	receive + take + person = recipient	うけとりニン (uketoriNIN)
引き受ける	pull + receive = to undertake	ひき うける (hiki ukeru)
受注	receive + pour = receipt of an order	ジュ・チュウ (JU-CHŪ)

{...} Sample Sentence

田中さんは新しい本を受け取りました。
Tanaka-san wa atarashii HON o uke torimashita.
(Tanaka-san) (new) (book) (received)
= Tanaka-san received a new book.

漢字 12: Evil (凶)

		
Evil. Misfortune.		

∈ Composition	
Glyphs	メ + 凵
English	ME + Wide open mouth/Container

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
Evil [men] [containers].

♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	キョウ (KYŌ)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Evil <KYŌTO>.

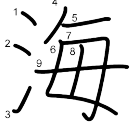
+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
凶年	evil + year = a bad year	キョウ・ネン (KYŌ-NEN)
凶行	evil + go = violence	キョウ・コウ (KYŌ-KŌ)

{...} Sample Sentence

凶年だそうです。
KYŌ-NEN da sō desu.
(bad year) (seems)
= Apparently it's a bad year.

漢字 13: Sea (海)

海		
Sea.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	氵 + 每
English	Water + Every (??)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
The sea has [water] [every] time.

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	カイ (KAI)	うみ (umi)
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Sea	<(KITE-SURFING) is <booming>.
-----	-------------------------------

+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
海	sea	うみ (umi)
海水	sea + water = <i>sea water</i>	カイ・スイ (KAI-SUI)
海図	sea + diagram = <i>nautical chart</i>	カイ・ズ (KAI-ZU)
海王星	sea + king + star = <i>Neptune (planet)</i>	カイ・オウ・セイ (KAI-Ō-SEI)
北海道	north + sea + road = <i>Hokkaido</i>	ホッカイ・ドウ (HOK-KAIDŌ)

{...} Sample Sentence
夏休みに北海道へ行きました。 natsu yasumi ni HOK-KAIDŌ e ikimashita. (summer vacation) (Hokkaido) (went) = (We) went to Hokkaido for summer vacation.

漢字 14: School (校)

校		
School.		
A secondary meaning related to “proof-reading” shows up in only a few compounds.		

	∈ Composition
Glyphs	木 + 交
English	Tree + Mix (5)

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components
A school is an environment where growing [trees] [mix].

	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	コウ (KŌ)	—
L.C.	—	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations
The school must have a noble (CAUSE).

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
Notice how 学 in the second example doubles up with 校, and how this remains constant in the other compounds in which this word occurs.		
校外	school + outside = <i>off-campus</i>	コウ・ガイ (KŌ-GAI)
学校	study + school = <i>school</i>	ガッ・コウ (GAK-KŌ)
小学校	small + study + school = <i>elementary school</i>	ショウ・ガッ・コウ (SHŌ-GAK-KŌ)
中学校	middle + study + school = <i>junior high school</i>	チュウ・ガッ・コウ (CHŪ-GAK-KŌ)
高校	tall + school = <i>high school</i>	コウ・コウ (KŌ-KŌ)
女学校	woman + study + school = <i>girls' school</i>	ジョ・ガッ・コウ (JO-GAK-KŌ)

{...} Sample Sentence
あの女の子は高校二年生です。 ano onna no ko wa KŌ-KŌ NINEN-SEI desu. (that) (woman) (child) (high school) (second year student) = That girl is a second-year high school student.

漢字 15: Leg (足)

足

足

Confusingly for English speakers, this character can signify both “leg” and “foot”.

A secondary meaning relates to the sense of “suffice”.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	足
English	Foot/Leg

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Part of the 漢字 radicals (#157).

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ソク (SOKU)	あし (ashi)
L.C.	—	た (ta)

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

The leg was <ushered> into the <tunnel> <SOCK>.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
Note that 取 is voiced in the fourth example.		
足	leg; foot	あし (ashi)
足首	leg + neck = <i>ankle</i>	あし・くび (ashikubi)
*足音	leg + sound = <i>sound of footsteps</i>	あしおと (ashimoto)
足取り	leg + take = <i>one's gait</i>	あし どり (ashi dori)
土足	earth + leg = <i>with shoes on</i>	ド・ソク (DO-SOKU)
*足元注意	leg + basis + pour + mind = “ <i>watch your step</i> ”	あしもと・チュウイ (ashimoto-CHŪ-I)

** Irregular Reading(s)

Kanji	English	Pronunciation
裸足*	naked + leg = <i>barefoot</i>	はだし (hadashi)

{...} Sample Sentence

足音を聞きましたか。
ashimoto o kikimashita ka.
(sound of footsteps) (heard)
= <i>Did you hear footsteps?</i>

漢字 16: Thread (糸)

糸

糸

Thread.

This character appears as a component in more than sixty other 漢字.

∈ Composition

Glyphs	糸
English	Thread

♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Part of the 漢字 radicals (#120).

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	—	いと (ito)
L.C.	シ (SHI)	—

♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Thread <SHIELDS> against <e-tolling>.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
Note that 口 is voiced in the second example.		
糸	thread	いと (ito)
糸口	thread + mouth = <i>beginning; clue</i>	いとぐち (itoguchi)

{...} Sample Sentence

青い糸がありますか。
aoi ito ga arimasu ka.
(blue) (thread) (is)
= <i>Is there any blue thread?</i>

漢字 17: Same (同)

同	同	
Same.		

∈ Composition

Glyphs	冂 + 一 + 口
English	To enclose/Wilderness + One + Mouth

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Same	[vampires] are found in [one] [wilderness].
------	---

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ドウ (DŌ)	おな (ona)
Remember that おな differs from おんな, a reading for 女 in Entry ??.		
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Same <onanism> ⟨DOORWAY⟩.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
同じ	same	おなじ (onaji)
同意	same + mind = <i>agreement</i>	ドウイ (DŌ-I)
同一	same + one = <i>identical</i>	ドウイツ (DŌ-ITSU)
同時	same + time = <i>simultaneous</i>	ドウジ (DŌ-JI)
同化	same + change = <i>assimilation</i>	ドウカ (DŌ-KA)
同行者	same + go + individual = <i>traveling companion</i>	ドウカシャ (DŌ-KŌ-SHA)

{...} Sample Sentence

私と中村さんは同時に来ました。
watashi to Nakamura-san wa DŌ-JI ni kimashita.
(I) (Nakamura-san) (simultaneous) (came)
= Nakamura-san and I arrived at the same time.

漢字 18: Noon (午)

午	午	
Noon.		

∈ Composition

Glyphs	ノ + 干
English	NO/slash + Dry

♠ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components

Noon	[drying] is a [no-no].
------	------------------------

♪ Pronunciations

	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	ゴ (GO)	—
L.C.	—	—

♠♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations

Noon ⟨GOBBLING⟩.

+ Words and Compounds

Example	English	Pronunciation
午前	noon + before = <i>A.M.; morning</i>	ゴゼン (GO-ZEN)
午後	noon + after = <i>P.M.; afternoon</i>	ゴゴ (GO-GO)
午前中	noon + before + middle = <i>all morning</i>	ゴゼンチュウ (GO-ZEN-CHŪ)

{...} Sample Sentence

午前八時に高校へ行きます。
GOZEN HACHI-JI ni KŌ-KŌ e ikimasu.
(A.M.) (eight o'clock) (high school) (go)
= I go to high school at 8 A.M.

漢字 19: Love (愛)		
		
Love.		
	∈ Composition	
Glyphs	爪 + 冫 + 心 + 夂	
English	Claw + Cover/Crown + Heart + Winter	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Lovely	[claws] [covering] [hearts] in [winter].	
	♪ Pronunciations	
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	アイ (AI)	—
L.C.	—	—
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Love	melts the (ICE) away.	

+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
愛好	love + like = <i>love</i> ; <i>like</i>	アイ・コウ (AIKŌ)
愛犬	love + dog = <i>pet</i> <i>dog</i>	アイ・ケン (AIKEN)
愛犬家	love + dog + house = <i>dog lover</i>	アイ・ケン・カ (AIKEN-KA)
愛鳥家	love + bird + house = <i>bird lover</i>	アイ・チョウ・カ (AICHŌ-KA)
愛国心	love + country + heart = <i>patriotism</i>	アイ・コク・シン (AIKOKU-SHIN)
** Irregular Reading(s)		
Kanji	English	Pronunciation
可愛い	possible + love = <i>cute</i>	カ・ワイ・イ (KA-WAIi)
{...} Sample Sentence		
本田さんは愛鳥家として有名です。		
Honda-san wa AICHŌ-KA toshite YŪ-MEI desu.		
(Honda-san) (bird lover) (as) (famous)		
= Honda-san is famous as a bird lover.		

漢字 20: Separate (離)		
		
Separate. Leave.		
∈ Composition		
Glyphs	亠 + 凶 + 内 + 隹	
English	Top/Lid + Evil (12) + Track/Animal Stamping + Old birds	
♣ ∈ Meaning ↔ Glyph Components		
Separate	the [top], [evil], [tracked] [old birds].	
♪ Pronunciations		
	音読み	訓読み
Cm.	リ (RI)	はな (hana)
L.C.	—	—
♣♪ Meaning ↔ Pronunciations		
Separate	<hung-up> <LEAPS>.	

+ Words and Compounds		
Example	English	Pronunciation
離れる (intr.)	<i>to separate; to</i> <i>leave</i>	はなれる (hanareru)
離す (tr.)	<i>to separate</i> <i>(something)</i>	はなす (hanasu)
離れ離れ	separate + separate = <i>scattered;</i> <i>separated</i>	はなれ ばなれ (hanare banare)
切り離す (tr.)	cut + separate = <i>to cut off</i> <i>(something)</i>	きり はなす (kiri hanasu)
分離	part + separate = <i>separation</i>	ブン・リ (BUNRI)
離村	separate + village = <i>rural exodus</i>	リ・ソン (RISON)
{...} Sample Sentence		
山でその親子は離れ離れになってしまいました。		
yama de sono oyako wa hanare banare ni natte shimaimashita.		
(mountain) (that) (parent and child) (separated) (ended up)		
= That parent and child ended up getting separated on the mountain.		

Main Index of 漢字

A			E			Love	愛	12	R		
After	後	6	Evil	凶	8	M			Receive	受	8
B			F			Mix	交	5	S		
Black	黒	4	Fat	太	7	Most	最	6	Same	同	11
C			Forest	森	3	N			School	校	9
Car	車	7	G			Noon	午	11	Sea	海	9
D			Grove	林	3	Not	不	5	Separate	離	12
Dawn	旦	4	L						T		
			Leg	足	10				Thread	糸	10

漢字 by Stroke Count

4 Strokes		同	11	9 Strokes		12 Strokes	
不	5	糸	10	後	6	最	6
凶	8			海	9	森	3
午	11	7 Strokes					
太	7	足	10	10 Strokes		13 Strokes	
		車	7	校	9	愛	12
5 Strokes		8 Strokes		11 Strokes		18 Strokes	
旦	4	受	8	黑	4	離	12
6 Strokes		林	3				
交	5						